



NIRMAL HRIDAY, KOLKATA

HOME BODIES

Nestled deep in the narrow bylanes of south Kolkata, Nirmal Hriday provides a sanctuary to the destitute. Opened in 1952, two years after Mother Teresa formed the Missionaries of Charity—an order of nuns that has an international presence today—Nirmal Hriday provides shelter to 100 inmates as of now. Originally an abandoned Kali temple, Mother Teresa converted it into the home for the poor with the help of some Indian officials. The Missionaries of Charity does not maintain any record of their work. So those who wish to return to their homes, among them celebrities such as the late Usha, are

CARING TOUCH: Mother Teresa (right) and Sister Nirmala in 1997



SWEET CHARITY

Mother Teresa didn't accept government funding because it would involve keeping accounts and distract a Sister from the "real work" of serving the poor.



THE MISSING LINK: A bridge built by the BRO in J&K

COUNTER INSURGENCY AND JUNGLE WARFARE SCHOOL, MIZORAM KINGS OF THE JUNGLE

In 1970, nearly two decades after the Indian Army found its mettle tested fighting the fierce Nagas and Mizo guerrillas during their insurrection, a school was set up to impart training in jungle warfare. Today, the Counter Insurgency and Jungle Warfare School (CIJWS) at Vairengte, Mizoram, is the world's oldest institution imparting training in counter-insurgency and counter-terrorist operations. And today it is probably the world's best jungle warfare school where boots on the ground learn, as the motto of the school suggests, 'to fight the guerrilla like a guerrilla'. The mountains and jungle terrain help train personnel in the adversary's natural environment. The school's commandant Brigadier A.K. Ram waves aside any competition. "We are the benchmark," he says. And the army acknowledges the school's contribution in improving the security situation in the North-east, where normalcy has finally prevailed in five of the six troubled states. **by Sandeep Unnikrishnan**